
AP U.S. Government and Politics

Practice Exam and Notes

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UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

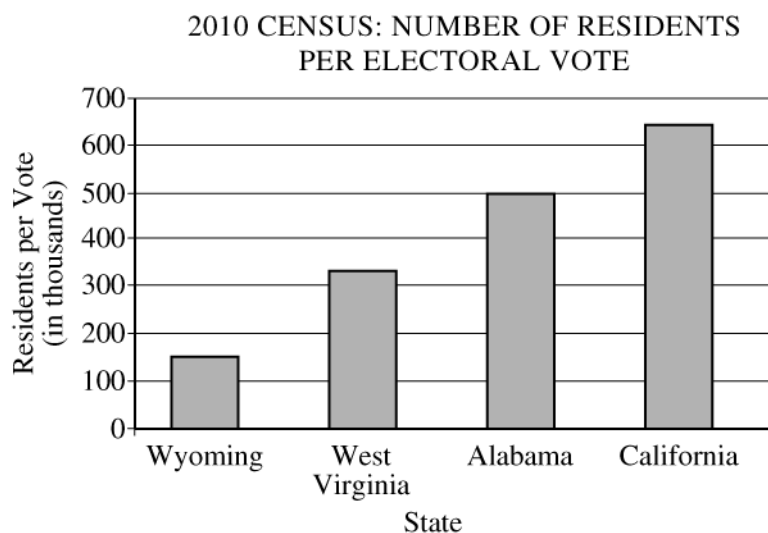
SECTION I

Time — 80 minutes

55 Questions

Directions: Each of the questions or incomplete statements below is followed by four suggested answers or completions. Select the one that is best in each case and then fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

Questions 1 - 2 refer to the graph.

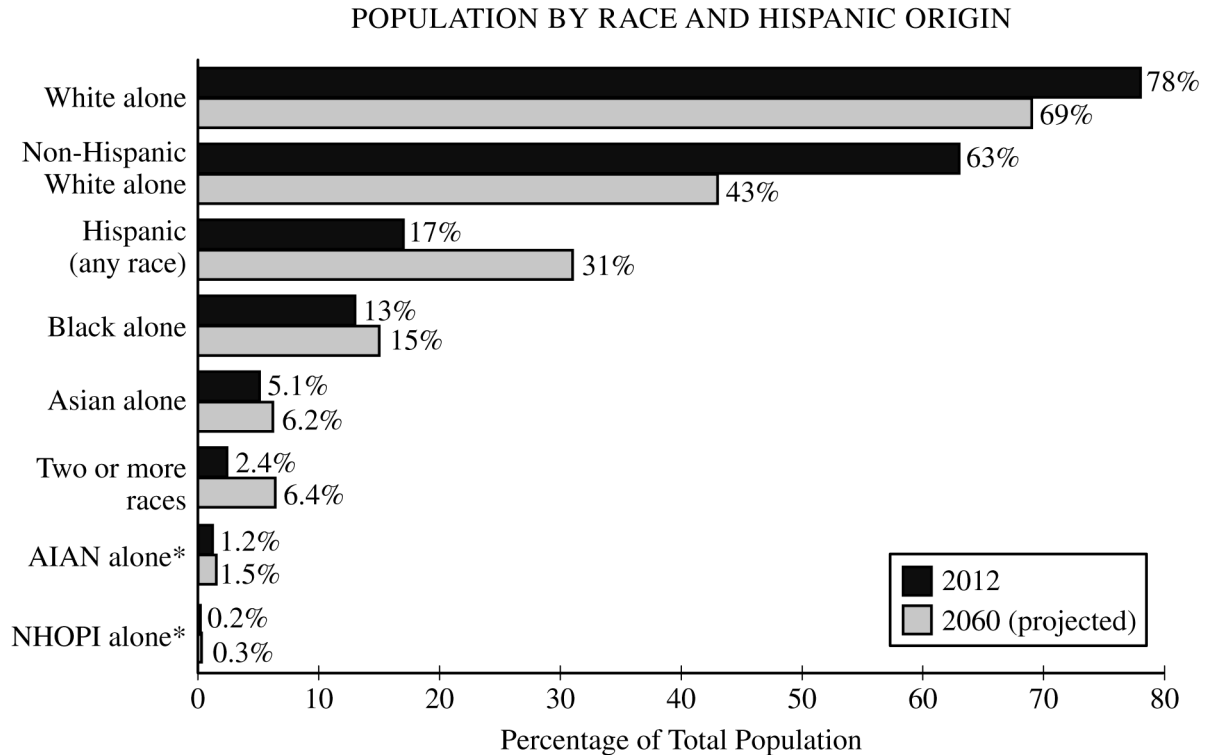


Source: United States Census Bureau, 2010

1. Given the information in the graph, in which of the following states would an individual's vote likely have more influence?
 - (A) Wyoming
 - (B) West Virginia
 - (C) Alabama
 - (D) California
2. The data in the graph best illustrate which of the following common criticisms of the electoral college?
 - (A) Small states have fewer electoral votes than large states and therefore have no impact on presidential elections.
 - (B) Individuals in small-population states have a greater impact on the electoral college than individuals in large-population states.
 - (C) Candidates from states with a large number of electoral votes have a major advantage in the electoral college.
 - (D) Smaller states have more electoral votes than larger states, which distorts the popular vote.

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Questions 3 - 4 refer to the bar graph.



*AIAN: American Indian and Alaskan Native
NHOPI: Native Hawaiian and Other Pacific Islander

Source: United States Census Bureau, 2012

3. According to the bar graph, which of the following statements will be true in the year 2060 ?
 - (A) The percentage of those identifying as Asian alone will be less than it was in 2012.
 - (B) Those identifying as White alone will remain a majority.
 - (C) Those identifying as Hispanic White will be 31% of the population.
 - (D) The percentage of those identifying as Black alone will be less than it was in 2012.
4. Which of the following is a likely effect of the trend depicted in the bar graph on voting and elections?
 - (A) There will be fewer restrictions placed on voting.
 - (B) Voter turnout is likely to increase among non-Whites.
 - (C) The Democratic Party will win more elections, based on current voting trends.
 - (D) There will be more retrospective voting among young voters.

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Questions 5 - 6 refer to the table.

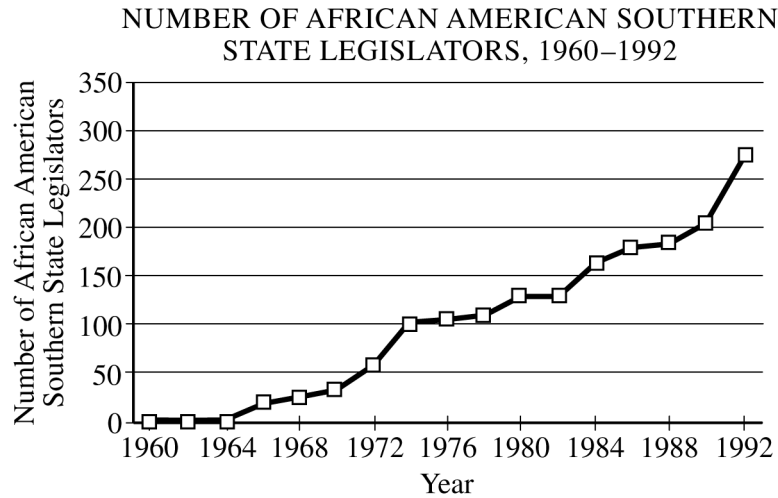
President and Term	Signing Statements Issued	Objections to Legislation Within the Signing Statement
Reagan (1981–1989)	250	86 (35%)
George H. W. Bush (1989–1993)	228	107 (47%)
Clinton (1993–2001)	381	70 (18%)
George W. Bush (2001–2009)	161	127 (79%)

Source: Table based on data from Todd Garvey, "Presidential Signing Statements: Constitutional and Institutional Implications," CRS Report, published January 4, 2012, <https://fas.org/sgp/crs/natsec/RL33667.pdf>

5. Which of the following statements is most accurately supported by the data in the table?
- (A) President Clinton greatly reduced the use of presidential signing statements compared with his predecessors.
 - (B) While President George W. Bush issued fewer signing statements than President Clinton, his included more objections than President Clinton's.
 - (C) President Clinton's brief access to the power of the line-item veto allowed him to issue fewer signing statements that raised concerns about legislation.
 - (D) President George W. Bush was forced to issue more signing statements as a direct result of the terrorist attacks of September 11, 2001.
6. Which of the following represents a reason that a president might use a signing statement to express displeasure with a bill as opposed to issuing a veto?
- (A) The president may have objections to provisions of a bill but does not want to risk Congress overriding a veto.
 - (B) Congress has severely curtailed the power of the president to withhold funds for bills that have been adopted.
 - (C) The Supreme Court is hesitant to acknowledge the president's power to veto legislation.
 - (D) The president wants to ensure executive agencies do not spend the money appropriated by Congress.

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Questions 7 - 8 refer to the line graph.



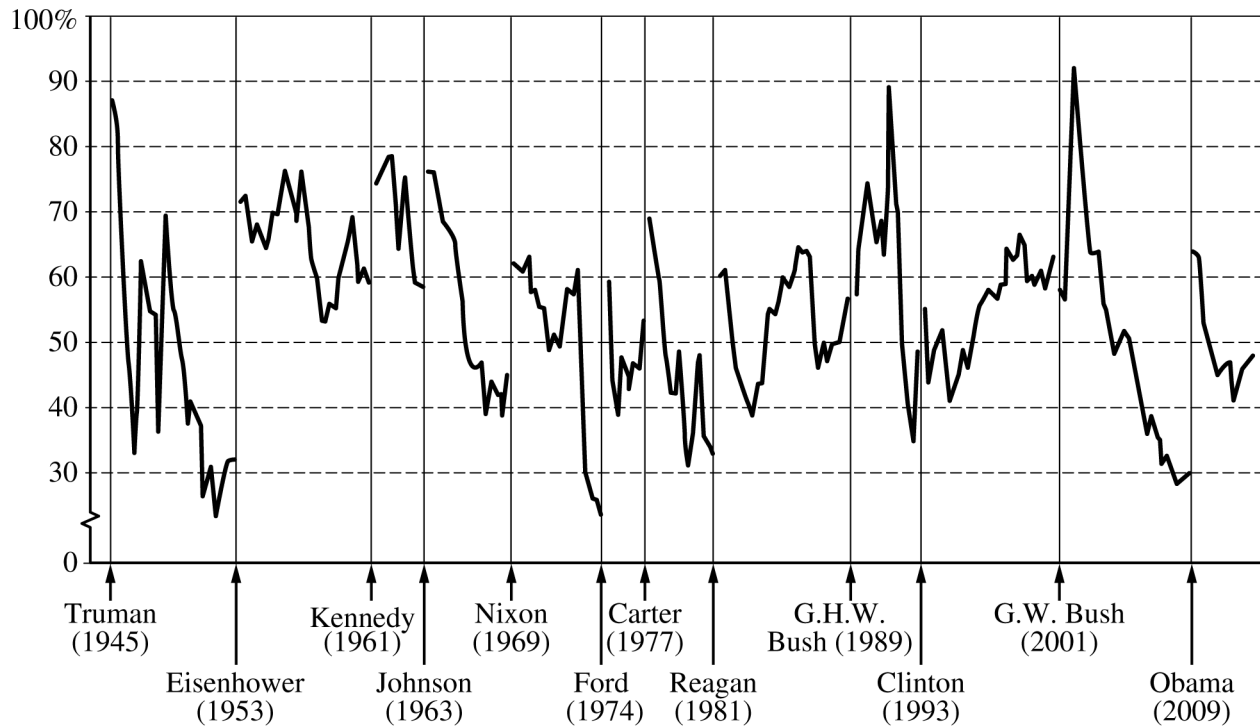
Source: Kousser, 1999

7. Which of the following statements presents the most important limitation of the data in the graph?
- (A) The time frame for the data is misleading.
 - (B) There is no information about the total number of state legislators.
 - (C) There are insufficient data points to detect a trend.
 - (D) The trend over time is potentially misleading and would be easier to read in a pie chart.
8. Which of the following is most likely responsible for the increase in the number of southern African American state legislators between 1960 and 1992 as shown in the graph?
- (A) The Civil Rights Act of 1964
 - (B) *Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka* (1954)
 - (C) The Voting Rights Act of 1965
 - (D) The Nineteenth Amendment

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Questions 9 - 10 refer to the line graph.

JOB APPROVAL RATINGS FOR PRESIDENTS, 1945-2012



Source: Gallup 2012.

9. Which of the following statements reflects a pattern in the line graph?

- (A) Nixon had the highest approval ratings of any president in the graph.
- (B) Most presidents exit office with lower approval ratings than when they entered office.
- (C) Most presidents begin their term with approval ratings lower than 50%.
- (D) Eisenhower had the lowest approval ratings of any president in the graph.

10. Which of the following correctly identifies an implication of the line graph?

- (A) Presidents are far more likely to make changes to the bureaucracy at the end of a second term than at the beginning of a first term.
- (B) Congress is more likely to act on a president's policy proposal at the beginning of a first term than at the end of a second term.
- (C) The Supreme Court is more likely to rule on an important case at the beginning of a first term than at the end of a second term.
- (D) Presidents are more likely to send troops into conflict at the end of a second term than at the beginning of a first term.

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Questions 11 - 13 refer to the passage.

I have already intimated to you the danger of parties in the State, with particular reference to the founding of them on geographical discriminations. Let me now take a more comprehensive view and warn you in the most solemn manner against the baneful effects of the spirit of party generally.

This spirit, unfortunately, is inseparable from our nature, having its root in the strongest passions of the human mind. It exists under different shapes in all governments, more or less stifled, controlled, or repressed; but, in those of the popular form, it is seen in its greatest rankness, and is truly their worst enemy.

The alternate domination of one faction over another, sharpened by the spirit of revenge, natural to party dissension, which in different ages and countries has perpetrated the most horrid enormities, is itself a frightful despotism. But this leads at length to a more formal and permanent despotism. The disorders and miseries which result gradually incline the minds of men to seek security and repose in the absolute power of an individual; and sooner or later the chief of some prevailing faction, more able or more fortunate than his competitors, turns this disposition to the purposes of his own elevation, on the ruins of public liberty.

Without looking forward to an extremity of this kind (which nevertheless ought not to be entirely out of sight), the common and continual mischiefs of the spirit of party are sufficient to make it the interest and duty of a wise people to discourage and restrain it. . . .

It is important, likewise, that the habits of thinking in a free country should inspire caution in those entrusted with its administration to confine themselves within their respective constitutional spheres, avoiding in the exercise of the powers of one department to encroach upon another. The spirit of encroachment tends to consolidate the powers of all the departments in one, and thus to create, whatever the form of government, a real despotism.

George Washington's Farewell Address, 1796

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| <p>11. Which of the following newspaper headlines best summarizes the excerpt from Washington's Farewell Address?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(A) Washington Boasts of the Potential of the New Republic(B) Washington Warns of Dangerous Party Factions(C) Washington Endorses a Stronger Executive Branch(D) Washington Takes Negative View of Checks and Balances | <p>12. In what respect does the Constitution address Washington's concern regarding the "spirit of encroachment" expressed in the excerpt?</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none">(A) The Constitution distributes power across national institutions.(B) The Constitution provides for equal representation of all citizens in Congress.(C) The Constitution requires a simple majority vote in Congress to overturn a veto.(D) The Constitution requires the Supreme Court to approve all legislation. |
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13. Which of the following scenarios illustrates Washington's concerns?
- (A) An increasing number of voters are not turning out to vote in elections.
 - (B) Federalism can lead to different public policy outcomes between states.
 - (C) Ideological divisions within Congress can lead to partisan gridlock.
 - (D) Members of the press fail to report on the illegal activities of certain members of the bureaucracy.

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Questions 14 - 17 refer to the passage.

In many places, classrooms are overcrowded and curricula are outdated. Most of our qualified teachers are underpaid, and many of our paid teachers are unqualified. So we must give every child a place to sit and a teacher to learn from. Poverty must not be a bar to learning, and learning must offer an escape from poverty.

But more classrooms and more teachers are not enough. We must seek an educational system which grows in excellence as it grows in size. This means better training for our teachers. It means preparing youth to enjoy their hours of leisure as well as their hours of labor. It means exploring new techniques of teaching, to find new ways to stimulate the love of learning and the capacity for creation. . . .

. . . While our Government has many programs directed at those issues, I do not pretend that we have the full answer to those problems.

But I do promise this: We are going to assemble the best thought and the broadest knowledge from all over the world to find those answers for America. I intend to establish working groups to prepare a series of White House conferences and meetings . . . on the quality of education, and on other emerging challenges. And from these meetings and from this inspiration and from these studies we will begin to set our course toward the Great Society.

The solution to these problems does not rest on a massive program in Washington, nor can it rely solely on the strained resources of local authority. They require us to create new concepts of cooperation, a creative federalism, between the National Capital and the leaders of local communities.

President Lyndon B. Johnson, May 22, 1964

14. By using the phrase “creative federalism,” President Johnson is most likely referring to which of the following features of the American system?
 - (A) The relationship between the federal and state governments evolves over time and is flexible enough to permit new forms of interaction.
 - (B) National policymaking is constrained by the sharing of power between the three branches of government.
 - (C) The balance of power between the states and federal government has been trending toward more federal regulation and less state control.
 - (D) Congress may use the commerce clause to address problems in public schools such as lack of resources and school safety.
15. Which of the following actions did President Johnson suggest he would take to address problems in public schools?
 - (A) Driving down the cost of education by removing ineffective teachers
 - (B) Calling on experts to advise the federal government in finding ways to improve public education
 - (C) Increasing school accountability by requiring schools to show evidence of improvement
 - (D) Scaling back the role of the federal government and allowing state and local governments to take the lead in education policy

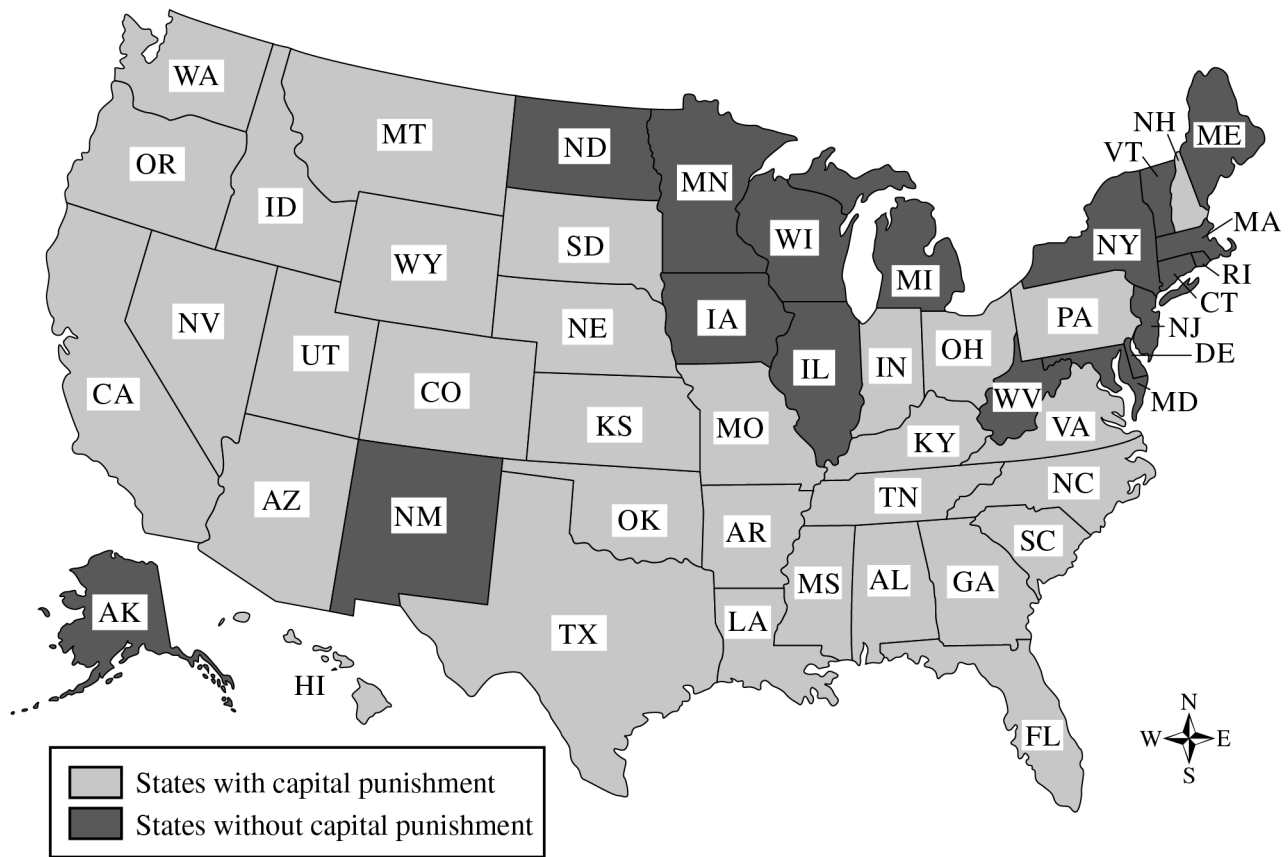
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16. Which of the following explains President Johnson's motivation for the speech in relation to his role as the head of the executive branch?
- (A) President Johnson believes that Congress will soon pass a bill on education reform, and he would like to be able to claim credit for it.
 - (B) President Johnson is seeking to use the bully pulpit as a means of promoting his agenda on public education.
 - (C) President Johnson is expecting the Supreme Court to soon rule on the constitutionality of a law passed by the previous administration.
 - (D) President Johnson is issuing an executive order calling on local governments to increase training for teachers and address poverty among students.
17. A liberal response to the "strained resources" of local government most likely would include
- (A) a reduction of federal income taxes so that state and local governments can use those resources
 - (B) less federal regulation and more authority for local school boards to create curricula and standards
 - (C) an increase in federal spending on public education and more programs aimed at helping lower-income communities
 - (D) encouraging state and local governments to offer vouchers so that students can attend private or charter schools

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Questions 18 - 19 refer to the map.

STATUS OF CAPITAL PUNISHMENT IN THE UNITED STATES BY STATE IN 2016



Source: National Conference of State Legislatures, 2017

18. Which of the following statements best describes the information in the map?

- (A) Most states in the Northeast and West do not allow capital punishment.
- (B) Most states in the South and West allow capital punishment.
- (C) Capital punishment is not allowed in Oklahoma (OK) and New Mexico (NM).
- (D) Only three states do not allow capital punishment.

19. Which of the following constitutional principles best explains why there is variation among states on the use of capital punishment?

- (A) Separation of powers
- (B) Judicial review
- (C) Checks and balances
- (D) Federalism

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Questions 20 - 21 refer to the political cartoon.



Herblock, *Washington Post*, 1949

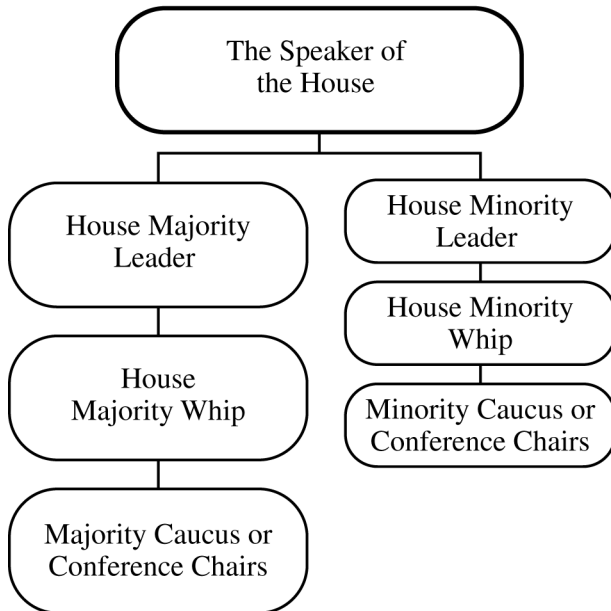
20. Which of the following is the most accurate interpretation of the political cartoon?
- (A) State governments have used the Tenth Amendment to override the federal government's mandates.
 - (B) State governments are unwilling to share their budgetary surpluses with other states.
 - (C) State governments prefer federal funding but do not want federal oversight over how the money is spent.
 - (D) The fiscal irresponsibility of state governments has led to increased federal regulation on their budgetary priorities.
21. Which of the following policies would the states most likely prefer according to the political cartoon?
- (A) Federal mandates
 - (B) Regulatory preemption
 - (C) Block grants
 - (D) Categorical grants

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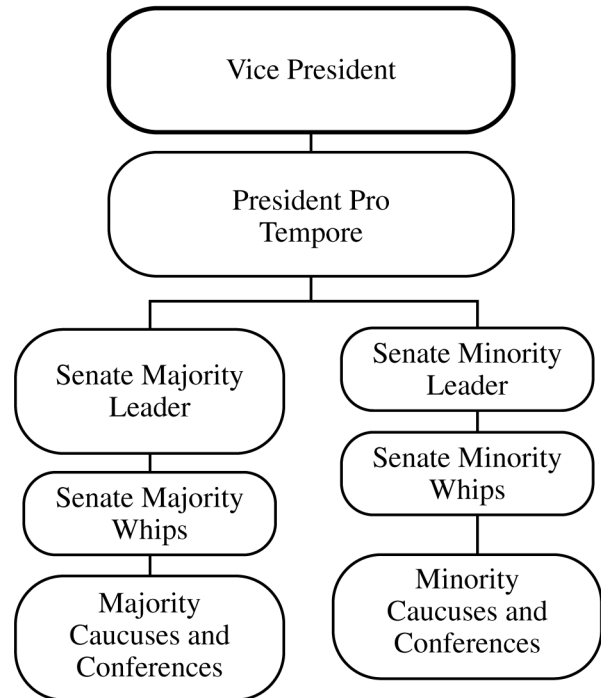
Questions 22 - 23 refer to the diagram.

CONGRESSIONAL LEADERSHIP

The House of Representatives



The Senate



22. Which of the following is true according to the diagram?

- (A) The Senate minority leader is as powerful as the Senate majority whip.
- (B) The Speaker of the House, in coordination with the House majority leader, appoints the House minority leader.
- (C) Unlike the House of Representatives, the Senate does not recognize political parties.
- (D) Both chambers make use of a system of majority and minority whips.

23. Based on your knowledge and the diagram, which of the following is true regarding the leadership structure of Congress?

- (A) The role of the minority leader in both the House of Representatives and the Senate is to coordinate a strategy for the minority party.
- (B) The vice president is responsible for creating and setting the legislative agenda for the Senate.
- (C) The Speaker of the House has very little power to control members of the majority party in the House of Representatives.
- (D) The majority leaders in both chambers work to ensure that a bipartisan agenda is passed in the Congress.

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24. In the 1780s, proponents of the new Constitution cited Shays' Rebellion as an example in support of which of the following criticisms of the national government under the Articles of Confederation?
- (A) The national government did not provide sufficient protection of individual rights.
 - (B) The lack of a centralized judiciary made enforcement of national laws difficult.
 - (C) States with larger populations were underrepresented in Congress.
 - (D) There was a lack of a national military power to address security concerns.
25. The majority party in the Senate is concerned that the Supreme Court has made a number of ideologically dangerous and controversial rulings. Which of the following actions would the Senate take in their attempt to limit the Supreme Court's power?
- (A) Replace the chief justice of the Supreme Court with someone with whom they agree with ideologically
 - (B) Pass legislation that would limit the impact of the Supreme Court's recent rulings
 - (C) Ratify a constitutional amendment limiting the Supreme Court's power
 - (D) Enforce term limits for justices on the Supreme Court
26. Which of the following describes an effect of the Twenty-Fourth Amendment?
- (A) It assured equal access to places of public accommodation regardless of race.
 - (B) It increased the importance of the Speaker of the House of Representatives.
 - (C) It reduced barriers to political participation on the basis of gender.
 - (D) It eliminated poll taxes.
27. Which of the following enumerated powers would permit Congress to stimulate the economy by hiring unemployed citizens?
- (A) The power to create immigration policies
 - (B) The power to regulate interstate commerce
 - (C) The power to pass a federal budget
 - (D) The power of legislative oversight
28. Which of the following is likely to occur as a result of new legislation regarding automobile safety?
- (A) The Supreme Court will be asked to review the legislation annually.
 - (B) States will be empowered to begin automobile manufacturing.
 - (C) The Department of Transportation will be given discretionary authority to create auto regulations.
 - (D) Mandatory spending will be required in all future federal budgeting for the program.
29. Which of the following best describes an exit poll?
- (A) A poll that asks voters at randomly selected voting places whom they voted for so that election results can be predicted more quickly
 - (B) A poll conducted by having a computer randomly select phone numbers from around the country
 - (C) An opinion poll that is used to intentionally sway people's opinions by using false or misleading information in the conversation
 - (D) A poll that randomly samples a population to capture public opinion at a given time

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30. The Supreme Court issued a ruling that was unpopular with a majority of Americans. The president and Congress might be able to lessen the impact of the decision by
- (A) reducing the pay of the justices to pressure them to reverse their decision
 - (B) overruling the Supreme Court's decision by a two-thirds vote in Congress
 - (C) impeaching the justices in the majority
 - (D) refusing to actively enforce the decision
31. Which of the following provides the most accurate explanation of how consumer-driven media increases partisan polarization?
- (A) Consumer-driven media tends to avoid discussing controversial political topics.
 - (B) Consumer-driven media reinforces existing political biases in individuals.
 - (C) Consumer-driven media relies heavily on corporate advertising.
 - (D) Consumer-driven media is overwhelmingly conservative.
32. In *The Federalist* 70, Alexander Hamilton states that "energy in the executive is a leading character in the definition of good government." In this statement, Hamilton is arguing in favor of the need for
- (A) a single executive who can respond quickly to crises
 - (B) a president who has a good understanding of public policy
 - (C) an electoral college in the selection of the president
 - (D) a president who is youthful and assertive
33. Which of the following Supreme Court decisions allows public school students to wear T-shirts protesting a school board decision that eliminates funding for high school arts programs?
- (A) *Engel v. Vitale* (1962)
 - (B) *Wisconsin v. Yoder* (1972)
 - (C) *Tinker v. Des Moines Independent Community School District* (1969)
 - (D) *New York Times Co. v. United States* (1971)
34. Concurrent powers have which of the following effects on the United States political system?
- (A) They reinforce the expansion of the power of the national government and the supremacy of the national law.
 - (B) They eliminate disputes between the states and the national government by creating completely separate spheres of influence.
 - (C) They foster cooperation between the states and the national government by requiring that the two levels of government work together.
 - (D) They make it possible for the states and the national government to simultaneously exercise influence in the same areas of public policy.

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35. Which of the following scenarios best illustrates a member of Congress supporting pork-barrel legislation?
- (A) A senator from a coal-producing state voting against a job-training program for coal miners
 - (B) A member of the House voting for urban renewal in exchange for increased funding for roads
 - (C) A senator from an agricultural state amending legislation to establish a potato research institute in his or her state
 - (D) A member of the House Armed Services Committee marking up a bill that will increase funding for military bases
36. If voters are acting according to the retrospective model of voting, which of the following will be the most important consideration in their decision?
- (A) The party affiliations of the candidates
 - (B) The campaign promises made by the candidates
 - (C) The effect of recent economic conditions on the voters
 - (D) Whether the candidates will act in the best interest of the voters if elected
37. During his confirmation hearing, Chief Justice John Roberts stated that *Roe v. Wade* (1973) “is the settled law of the land.” This statement suggests that in a case that challenges the constitutionality of legislation restricting privacy and reproductive rights, which of the following should be a key factor in the court’s ruling?
- (A) Briefs submitted by interested parties
 - (B) Contemporary societal norms
 - (C) The consensus of the other justices
 - (D) Reliance on legal precedent
38. Which of the following sets of policies appears to be most influenced by a libertarian ideology?
- (A) Increase income taxes on the wealthy to raise revenue for social security benefits.
 - (B) Legalize the commercial sale of marijuana and reduce government spending on prisons.
 - (C) Eliminate the estate tax and promote government-funded prekindergarten education.
 - (D) Expand the welfare state and reduce spending on national defense.
39. A state government places security cameras facing a popular site of protest in a public square in front of its statehouse. This scenario illustrates
- (A) how political attitudes quickly shift in the United States
 - (B) the balance of promoting stability and ensuring civil liberties
 - (C) the free-rider problem of organizing a civil rights protest
 - (D) the impact of globalization on individual political attitudes
40. Which of the following scenarios best reflects the process of political socialization?
- (A) An individual takes a civics course in school and develops opinions about politics.
 - (B) Members of Congress increasingly vote the same way as other members of their party.
 - (C) A group is able to attract new members by offering access to a broad network of people.
 - (D) As media choices increase, individuals expand their media consumption to new sources.

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41. Which of the following scenarios best illustrates a formal check on the power of the bureaucracy?
- (A) A lobbyist representing the National Rifle Association refusing to meet with employees from the Department of Homeland Security
 - (B) The secretary of defense being called to testify before a congressional committee
 - (C) The White House chief of staff being formally censured by the president for publically speaking out against the president's policy goals
 - (D) A federal judge being impeached for making legal decisions based on bribes
42. In a public opinion poll, a polling company used an online survey tool to randomly contact respondents who did not have telephone lines in addition to contacting people over the phone. Which of the following best explains this decision?
- (A) The company saved money because it did not need to hire as many telephone interviewers to conduct the poll.
 - (B) The company was establishing a benchmark poll at the beginning of a campaign.
 - (C) The company was interested in asking different questions to different individuals.
 - (D) The company wanted to ensure that the sample of the population was truly random.

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43. Which of the following is an accurate comparison of rights protected and not protected by the First Amendment?

	<u>Protected by the First Amendment</u>	<u>Not Protected by the First Amendment</u>
(A)	Libel/slander	Fighting words
(B)	Freedom of religion	Freedom of assembly
(C)	The right to burn a flag	Obscenity
(D)	Online newspapers	The right of a student to pray in school

44. Which of the following is the correct pairing of powers found in the Articles of Confederation and powers found in the Constitution?

	<u>Articles of Confederation</u>	<u>United States Constitution</u>
(A)	Protection of individual liberties	No protection of specific individual rights
(B)	Powerful executive branch	Federal government supreme over states
(C)	Unicameral legislature	Bicameral legislature
(D)	Amendment requires unanimity of all states	Amendment requires the president's approval

45. Which of the following accurately compares the formal and informal powers of the president?

	<u>Formal Power</u>	<u>Informal Power</u>
(A)	Vetoing legislation to prevent a bill from becoming law	Using a pocket veto to prevent a bill from becoming law
(B)	Using the bully pulpit to influence public opinion	Appointing ambassadors and receiving diplomats from other nations
(C)	Acting as commander in chief of the military	Signing executive agreements with foreign nations
(D)	Using the power of the purse to support government programs	Using signing statements to shape legislation

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46. Which of the following makes a correct comparison between political parties and interest groups in the United States?

	<u>Political Parties</u>	<u>Interest Groups</u>
(A)	Political parties recruit and run candidates in elections.	Interest groups seek to influence public policy.
(B)	Political parties have small constituencies and thus try to win elections by energizing their base to vote for them.	Interest groups alert and educate voters regarding pending legislation.
(C)	Political parties have organizations that donate money to candidates for public office.	Interest groups are barred by law from donating money to political campaigns.
(D)	Political parties achieve the bulk of the changes they seek through the use of the courts.	Interest groups build relationships with congressional committees and the bureaucracy to form iron triangles.

47. Which of the following sets of Supreme Court cases best illustrates how views of federalism have shifted in the United States?

	<u>Case 1</u>	<u>Case 2</u>
(A)	<i>Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka</i> (1954)	<i>Baker v. Carr</i> (1962)
(B)	<i>McCulloch v. Maryland</i> (1819)	<i>United States v. Lopez</i> (1995)
(C)	<i>Roe v. Wade</i> (1973)	<i>McDonald v. Chicago</i> (2010)
(D)	<i>Schenck v. United States</i> (1919)	<i>New York Times v. United States</i> (1971)

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48. Which of the following describes the potential impact on the electorate when daily media coverage of elections focuses primarily on the newest poll results?
- (A) The electorate will be increasingly divided along partisan lines.
 - (B) The electorate will be less likely to turn out to vote on Election Day.
 - (C) The electorate will be more likely to have expanded knowledge of the electoral process.
 - (D) The electorate will be less able to accurately compare the policy platforms of candidates running in the election.
49. Which of the following is an example of how separation of powers creates friction between the executive and legislative branches in the policy-making process?
- (A) The electoral college vote ends with no candidate receiving a majority of the votes, and the House of Representatives is delegated the task of selecting the next president.
 - (B) The Senate votes to impeach a sitting president for high crimes and misdemeanors.
 - (C) The secretary of state is dispatched along with a delegation of senators to negotiate a treaty with a foreign government.
 - (D) The president threatens to issue an executive order for stricter gun control if Congress continues to refuse to take action.
50. Which of the following scenarios is an example of the trustee model of representation?
- (A) The NAACP leadership sends representatives to Washington to lobby for changes to the Voting Rights Act.
 - (B) Congress passes a bill allocating money to clean up nuclear waste sites after a wave of large-scale peaceful protests.
 - (C) A member of Congress votes to close a popular tax loophole based on the belief that the money would be better spent paying down the national debt.
 - (D) A presidential candidate advocates using an executive order to increase the minimum wage for federal contractors.
51. Two interest groups are competing for influence in Congress. One group represents banking institutions, while the other advocates for consumer protections. A critic of the influence of interest groups would make which of the following claims?
- (A) The interest groups will nominate a slate of candidates for office to compete against each other in the next election in order to determine which interests prevail.
 - (B) The consumer protection group will appeal only to Republican leaders, while the banking interests will appeal only to Democratic leaders.
 - (C) The banking interest group likely has greater financial resources and access to policy makers than the consumer protection group.
 - (D) The consumer protection group is prohibited by federal regulations from direct lobbying.

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52. In which of the following situations would the Supreme Court be most likely to utilize the doctrine of selective incorporation?
- (A) When an individual claims that a right protected by the Bill of Rights is infringed upon by a state
 - (B) When there is a conflict among the branches of the national government
 - (C) When a federal policy shifting oversight authority from a national agency to a state agency is challenged
 - (D) When a former employee files a wrongful termination claim against a company headquartered in another state
53. Which of the following is a true statement about the role of the media in providing citizens with information?
- (A) Investigative reporting dominates the news because it is less expensive than political commentary.
 - (B) Demand for instantaneous news reporting has led to the growth of 24-hour news operations and a shift to online media consumption.
 - (C) The media is increasingly controlled by the major political parties, who determine which stories are covered by the press.
 - (D) There has been an increase in social media and Internet news consumption by the public, causing the top five media conglomerates to have greater control over public opinion.
54. A public school district implemented a policy that allowed students to vote on whether they wanted a student-led prayer to be read at football games. This policy was later found to be unconstitutional by the United States Supreme Court. Which of the following clauses did the policy most likely violate?
- (A) The interstate commerce clause
 - (B) The free exercise clause
 - (C) The supremacy clause
 - (D) The establishment clause
55. Which of the following policies would an individual who identifies as a Democrat most likely support?
- (A) Reducing regulations on Wall Street to stimulate economic growth
 - (B) Decreasing the role of the federal government to ensure access to health care
 - (C) Increasing federal enforcement of immigration laws
 - (D) Strengthening anti-discrimination policies for married gay couples

STOP
END OF EXAM

UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

SECTION II

Time — 1 hour and 40 minutes

Directions: It is suggested that you take a few minutes to plan and outline each answer. It is suggested that you spend approximately 20 minutes each on questions 1, 2, and 3 and 40 minutes on question 4. Unless directions indicate otherwise, respond to all parts of all four questions. In your response use substantive examples where appropriate.

1. The following is from the 2016 Republican Party Platform.

“Because the Federal Reserve’s monetary policy decisions affect job creation, upward mobility for workers, and equitable prosperity, they should be transparent. Similarly, the Federal Reserve’s important role as a lender of last resort should also be carried out in a more transparent manner. The Republican Party will advance legislation that brings transparency and accountability to the Federal Reserve, the Federal Open Market Committee, and the Federal Reserve’s dealing with foreign banks.”

<https://www.gop.com/the-2016-republican-party-platform/>

After reading the scenario, respond to A, B, and C below.

- A. Describe an action, other than advancing legislation, that members of Congress may take to bring transparency and accountability to the Federal Reserve.
- B. In the context of this section of the Republican Party platform, explain how the proposal to increase transparency and accountability described in part A would affect the Federal Reserve’s ability to make economic policy.
- C. Explain how ideological differences between the parties might affect Democratic Party support of the proposal.

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	Johnson (D)	Nixon (R)	Ford (R)	Carter (D)	Reagan (R)	G. Bush (R)	Clinton (D)	G. W. Bush (R)
Gender								
Male	98.4%	99.4%	98.1%	85.6%	91.7%	80.4%	71.5%	80.3%
Female	1.6%	0.6%	1.9%	14.4%	8.3%	19.6%	28.5%	19.7%
Party								
Democratic	94.3%	7.3%	21.2%	91.1%	4.8%	6.1%	87.5%	6.9%
Republican	5.7%	92.7%	78.8%	4.5%	91.7%	88.5%	6.2%	84.7%
Independent	0%	0%	0%	4.5%	3.4%	5.4%	6.3%	8.4%
Number of Federal District Court Appointees	125	182	50	203	290	148	305	261

Use the information graphic above to answer the following questions.

- [illegible]

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[illegible]

3. In 2010 Arizona passed a law that sought to reduce the number of undocumented immigrants in the state. The law made it a crime to seek or obtain work in the state without proper documentation, and it also made hiring, sheltering, or transporting undocumented people illegal. It also gave local law enforcement the authority to require proof of residency in the course of a lawful arrest, and it gave them the authority to perform warrantless stops of people they suspected of being undocumented.

The United States Department of Justice challenged the state law as an interference with the national government's enumerated powers to regulate and enforce immigration law. In *Arizona v. United States* (2012), the Supreme Court agreed with the United States in a 6–3 decision stating most of the provisions of the law did conflict with federal authority. The Court said, “The Government of the United States has broad, undoubted power over the subject of immigration and the status of aliens. . . . This authority rests, in part, on the National Government's constitutional power to establish a uniform Rule of Naturalization, and its inherent power as sovereign to control and conduct relations with foreign nations.”

Based on the information above, respond to the following questions.

- A. Identify a common constitutional principle used to make a ruling in both *McCulloch v. Maryland* (1819) and *Arizona v. United States* (2012).
- B. Explain how the facts of *McCulloch v. Maryland* and the facts of *Arizona v. United States* led to a similar holding in both cases.
- C. Describe an action that Congress could take to respond to the *Arizona v. United States* decision if it disagreed with the decision.

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[illegible]

4. Equality of opportunity is a central value in the American political system. Choose either Congress or the Supreme Court, and present an argument for why your choice is most responsible for advancing the principle of equality of opportunity in the United States.

In your essay, you must:

- ✓ Articulate a defensible claim or thesis that responds to the prompt and establishes a line of reasoning.
- ✓ Support your claim with at least TWO pieces of accurate and relevant information.
 - At least ONE piece of evidence must be from the list below.
 - Constitutional amendments
 - The Declaration of Independence
 - *Federalist* 78
 - The second piece of evidence must be from a different source on the list above OR from your knowledge of Congress or the Supreme Court.
- ✓ Use reasoning to explain why your evidence supports your claim/thesis.
- ✓ Respond to an opposing or alternative perspective using refutation, concession, or rebuttal.

The image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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Answer Key and Question Alignment to Course Framework

Multiple-Choice Question	Answer	Disciplinary Practice	Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1	A	3.a	PRD-2.A	5
2	B	3.d	PRD-2.B	5
3	B	3.a	MPA-3.C	5
4	C	3.d	MPA-3.C	5
5	B	3.a	CON-4.B	2
6	A	1.b	CON-4.A	2
7	B	3.e	PMI-3.A	3
8	C	3.d	PMI-3.A	3
9	B	3.b	CON-4.A	2
10	B	3.d	CON-4.A	2
11	B	4.a	CON-1.A	1
12	A	4.c	PMI-1.B	1
13	C	4.c	CON-3.C	2
14	A	4.a	CON-2.A	1
15	B	4.a	CON-2.C	1
16	B	4.c	CON-4.D	2
17	C	4.c	PMI-4.C	4
18	B	4.a	LOR-2.D	3
19	D	4.c	CON-2.C	1
20	C	4.a	CON-2.A	1
21	C	4.c	CON-2.A	1
22	D	4.a	CON-3.B	2
23	A	4.b	CON-3.B	2
24	D	1.a	CON-1.B	1
25	B	1.e	CON-5.C	2
26	D	1.b	MPA-3.A	5
27	C	1.a	CON-3.A	2
28	C	1.e	PMI-2.B	2
29	A	1.a	MPA-2.A	4
30	D	1.a	CON-5.C	2
31	B	1.b	PRD-3.B	5
32	A	1.a	CON-4.C	2
33	C	1.e	LOR-2.C	3
34	D	1.b	CON-2.A	1
35	C	1.d	CON-3.B	2
36	C	1.a	MPA-3.B	5
37	D	1.e	CON-5.B	2
38	B	1.a	PMI-4.E	4
39	B	1.d	PMI-4.B	4
40	A	1.d	MPA-1.B	4

Multiple-Choice Question	Answer	Disciplinary Practice	Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
41	B	1.d	PMI-2.C	2
42	D	1.e	MPA-2.A	4
43	C	1.c	LOR-2.C	3
44	C	1.c	CON-1.B	1
45	C	1.c	CON-4.A	2
46	A	1.c	PMI-5.G	5
47	B	2.c	CON-2.B	1
48	D	1.b	PRD-3.A	5
49	D	1.e	PMI-1.B	1
50	C	1.d	CON-3.C	2
51	C	1.e	PMI-5.F	5
52	A	1.e	LOR-3.A	3
53	B	1.b	PRD-3.B	5
54	D	2.d	LOR-2.C	3
55	D	1.a	PMI-4.A	4

Multiple-Choice Section

In Section I, there are 55 multiple-choice questions. Section I is organized into individual multiple-choice questions as well as sets of two to four questions that ask students to respond to stimulus material—including texts, images, charts, graphs, maps, etc. Each multiple-choice question will address one of the learning objectives for the course, as well as test one of the disciplinary practices discussed in the course framework.

Course Framework Alignment and Rationales

Question 1

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.a Describe the data presented.		PRD-2.A Explain how the different processes work in a U.S. presidential election.	5
(A)	This option is correct. The graph shows that individuals casting votes in Wyoming would have more influence because of the smaller number of residents per electoral vote.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The graph shows that individuals casting votes in West Virginia would not have as much influence as those in other states because of the larger number of residents per vote.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The graph shows that individuals casting votes in Alabama would not have as much influence as those in other states because of the larger number of residents per vote.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The graph shows that individuals casting votes in California would not have as much influence as those in other states because of the larger number of residents per vote.		

Question 2

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.d Explain what the data imply or illustrate about political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PRD-2.B Explain how the Electoral College impacts democratic participation.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. The chart does not illustrate the criticism that smaller states have fewer electoral votes and so do not have an impact on presidential elections.		
(B)	This option is correct. The chart best illustrates the criticism that citizens living in states with smaller populations have a larger impact in the electoral college.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The chart does not illustrate the criticism that candidates from states with a large number of electoral votes have an advantage in the electoral college.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The chart does not illustrate the criticism that smaller states have more electoral college votes than larger states.		

Question 3

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.a Describe the data presented.		MPA-3.C Explain the roles that individual choice and state laws play in voter turnout in elections.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. The graph shows the percentage of people identifying as Asian increasing.		
(B)	This option is correct. The graph shows the percentage of people identifying as White alone remaining a majority at 69%.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The graph does not show the percentage of people identifying as Hispanic White.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The graph shows the percentage of the population identifying as Black alone increasing from 13% to 15%.		

Question 4

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.d Explain what the data imply or illustrate about political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		MPA-3.C Explain the roles that individual choice and state laws play in voter turnout in elections.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. Demographic trends do not necessarily affect restrictions on voting.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The demographic shift depicted in the graph does not necessarily result in any specific change in voter turnout.		
(C)	This option is correct. The demographic shift will benefit the Democratic Party if current voting trends continue.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Demographic changes do not necessarily have an effect on retrospective voting.		

Question 5

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.a Describe the data presented.		CON-4.B Explain how the president's agenda can create tension and frequent confrontations with Congress.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. President Clinton issued more signing statements than both of his predecessors.		
(B)	This option is correct. George W. Bush did issue fewer signing statements, but his included 127 objections, as opposed to Clinton's 70.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The table shows that President Clinton issued the most signing statements of those listed, which would not support the theory that temporary access to the line-item veto allowed him to issue fewer signing statements.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The terrorist attacks of September 11, 2001, did not necessitate more signing statements; George W. Bush actually issued fewer signing statements.		

Question 6

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.b Explain political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-4.A Explain how the president can implement a policy agenda.	2
(A)	This option is correct. The president can use a signing statement to register protest when a veto override is likely.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The president does not have control over the national budget and cannot control approval of funding levels.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The president's power to veto is enumerated in the Constitution.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Signing statements do not allow the president to prevent agencies from spending money appropriated by Congress.		

Question 7

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.e Explain possible limitations of the data provided.		PMI-3.A Explain how the government has responded to social movements.	3
(A)	This option is incorrect. The time frame for the data is not misleading.		
(B)	This option is correct. One important limitation of the chart is that it does not tell the total number of all state legislators. This information is relevant for understanding the cause of the trend.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. There are enough data points to detect a clear trend.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. These data do not need a pie chart to be clearly depicted.		

Question 8

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.d Explain what the data imply or illustrate about political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PMI-3.A Explain how the government has responded to social movements.	3
(A)	This option is incorrect. The Civil Rights Act of 1964 did not extend any new protections to African Americans in the voting booth.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. In <i>Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka</i> (1954), the Supreme Court did not extend any new protections to African Americans in the voting booth.		
(C)	This option is correct. The Voting Rights Act of 1965 made it illegal to discriminate against African Americans in polling places in the South which is a likely explanation for the increase in African American legislators.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The Nineteenth Amendment did not extend any additional protections to African Americans in the voting booth.		

Question 9

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.b Describe patterns and trends in data.		CON-4.A Explain how the president can implement a policy agenda.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. The graph does not show that Nixon had the highest approval ratings of any president represented.		
(B)	This option is correct. The graph shows that most presidents exit office with lower approval ratings than they had when they were elected.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The graph does not show that most presidents begin their terms with approval ratings lower than 50%.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The graph does not show that Eisenhower had the lowest approval ratings of any president represented.		

Question 10

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
3.d Explain what the data imply or illustrate about political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-4.A Explain how the president can implement a policy agenda.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. Presidents are not more likely to make changes to the bureaucracy at the end of the second term than at the beginning of a first term.		
(B)	This option is correct. The most accurate implication is that Congress is more likely to act on a president's policy at the beginning of a first term than at the end of second term.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The Supreme Court is not more likely to rule on an important case at the beginning of a first term than at the end of a second term.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Presidents are not more likely to send troops into conflict at the end of the second term than at the beginning of a first term.		

Question 11

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.a Describe the author's claim(s), perspective, evidence, and reasoning.		CON-1.A Explain how Federalist and Anti-Federalist views on central government and democracy are reflected in U.S. foundational documents.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. "Washington Boasts of the Potential of the New Republic" does not summarize Washington's Farewell Address.		
(B)	This option is correct. "Washington Warns of Dangerous Party Factions" is the newspaper headline that best summarizes Washington's Farewell Address.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. "Washington Endorses a Stronger Executive Branch" does not summarize Washington's Farewell Address.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. "Washington Takes Negative View of Checks and Balances" does not summarize Washington's Farewell Address.		

Question 12

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.c Explain how the implications of the author's argument or perspective may affect political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PMI-1.B Explain the implications of separation of powers and checks and balances for the U.S. political system.	1
(A)	This option is correct. Distributing power across national institutions was designed to address the "spirit of encroachment" mentioned in the passage.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Some features of the Constitution provide for equal representation for citizens in Congress, but this does not address Washington's concern in the passage.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The Constitution does not require a simple majority to override a veto.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The Constitution does not require the Supreme Court to approve all legislation.		

Question 13

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.c Explain how the implications of the author's argument may affect political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-3.C Explain how congressional behavior is influenced by election processes, partisanship, and divided government.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. Washington does not express concern about voter turnout rates.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Washington does not express concern about different public policy outcomes in different states.		
(C)	This option is correct. Washington expresses concern about parties interfering with the operation of good government. Gridlock is caused by parties not willing to work with each other to pass important legislation.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Washington does not express concern about members of the press not reporting on the illegal activities of the bureaucracy.		

Question 14

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.a Describe the author's claim(s), perspective, evidence, and reasoning.		CON-2.A Explain how societal needs affect the constitutional allocation of power between the national and state governments.	1
(A)	This option is correct. Johnson is referring to the evolving relationship between levels of government.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Johnson is not referring to the constraints of power sharing.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Johnson is not referring to the trend toward more federal control over states.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Johnson is not referring to the commerce clause.		

Question 15

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.a Describe the author's claim(s), perspective, evidence, and reasoning.		CON-2.C Explain how the distribution of powers among three federal branches and between national and state governments impacts policy making.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. Johnson does not suggest removing ineffective teachers.		
(B)	This option is correct. Johnson does suggest calling on experts to advise the federal government.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Johnson does not suggest increasing accountability for schools.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Johnson does not suggest scaling back the federal government role in education.		

Question 16

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.c Explain how implications of the author's argument or perspective may affect political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-4.D Explain how communication technology has changed the president's relationship with the national constituency and the other branches.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. Johnson is not attempting to anticipate what legislation Congress will pass, but rather influence what legislation Congress will pass.		
(B)	This option is correct. Johnson is using the bully pulpit to promote an agenda.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Johnson is not expecting the Supreme Court to rule on a law.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Johnson is not issuing an executive order.		

Question 17

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.c Explain how the implications of the author's argument may affect political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PMI-4.C Describe different political ideologies on the role of government in regulating the marketplace.	4
(A)	This option is incorrect. Liberals do not favor tax cuts as a means of helping local governments.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Liberals do not believe that less federal regulation and more authority for school boards will provide greater resources to local governments.		
(C)	This option is correct. Liberals believe that an increase in federal spending on public education and more programs aimed at helping lower-income communities will provide greater resources to local governments.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Liberals do not believe that school vouchers will provide greater resources to local governments.		

Question 18

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.a Describe the author's claim(s), perspective, evidence, and reasoning.		LOR-2.D Explain how the Supreme Court has attempted to balance claims of individual freedom with laws and enforcement procedures that promote public order and safety.	3
(A)	This option is incorrect. Most states in the West do allow capital punishment.		
(B)	This option is correct. Most states in the South and West allow capital punishment.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Oklahoma allows capital punishment.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. More than three states do not allow capital punishment.		

Question 19

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.c Explain how the implications of the author’s argument or perspective may affect political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-2.C Explain how the distribution of powers among three federal branches and between national and state governments impacts policy making.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. Separation of powers does not explain variation among the states.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Judicial review does not explain variation among the states.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Checks and balances does not explain variation among the states.		
(D)	This option is correct. Federalism allows states to develop their own policies, and so it explains variation among the states.		

Question 20

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.a Describe the author’s claim(s), perspective, evidence, and reasoning.		CON-2.A Explain how societal needs affect the constitutional allocation of power between the national and state governments.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. The cartoon does not suggest that the Tenth Amendment has been used to override federal mandates.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The cartoon does not suggest that state governments are unwilling to share their budgetary surpluses with other states.		
(C)	This option is correct. The cartoon suggests that states want federal money, depicted by the money bag offered by Uncle Sam, but do not want federal oversight, depicted by the gesture of rejection given by the “states’ rights” advocate to the paper that says “federal authority” held by Uncle Sam.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The cartoon does not suggest that fiscal irresponsibility has led to increased federal regulation.		

Question 21

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.c Explain how the implications of the author's argument may affect political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-2.A Explain how societal needs affect the constitutional allocation of power between the national and state governments.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. States do not want federal mandates, according to the cartoon, since they involve federal oversight.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Regulatory preemption is not a form of regulations that states want, according to the cartoon, since it involves federal oversight.		
(C)	This option is correct. Block grants provide money to states without great oversight by the federal government, which appeals to states, according the cartoon.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Since categorical grants provide money to states but come with very specific instructions on how it is spent, states do not want them, according to the cartoon.		

Question 22

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.a Describe the author's claim(s), perspective, evidence, and reasoning.		CON-3.B Explain how the structure, powers, and functions of both houses of Congress affect the policy-making process.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. The diagram shows that the Senate minority leader and the Senate majority whip are from two different parties and have different levels of power.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The diagram shows the Speaker of the House is above the House minority leader, and they are from two different parties.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The diagram does not illustrate that the Senate does not recognize political parties.		
(D)	This option is correct. The diagram illustrates the system of majority and minority whips used in the House of Representatives and the Senate to generate support on legislation.		

Question 23

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
4.b Explain how the author's argument or perspective relates to political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-3.B Explain how the structure, powers, and functions of both houses of Congress affect the policy-making process.	2
(A)	This option is correct. The minority leader in each house of Congress coordinates strategy for the minority party.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The vice president is responsible for casting a tie-breaking vote in the Senate but not for creating the legislative agenda.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. One of the Speaker's jobs is to be the leader of the House's majority party, and therefore the Speaker has considerable power to control members of the majority party.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The majority leaders in both chambers control their own agendas but do not work to ensure that a bipartisan agenda is passed.		

Question 24

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-1.B Explain the relationship between key provisions of the Articles of Confederation and the debate over granting the federal government greater power formerly reserved to the states.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. Sufficient protection of individual rights was not one of the main criticisms of the Articles of Confederation stemming from Shays' Rebellion.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Shays' Rebellion did not illustrate the criticism that there was a lack of a centralized judiciary.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Concern about large-state representation in Congress was addressed in the Great Compromise, but it was not a criticism originating with Shays' Rebellion.		
(D)	This option is correct. The inability of the national government to respond militarily to Shays' Rebellion showed that the government was not very strong.		

Question 25

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		CON-5.C Explain how other branches in the government can limit the Supreme Court's power.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. The Senate does not have the power to replace Supreme Court justices.		
(B)	This option is correct. The Senate can check the power of the Supreme Court by passing legislation that limits the impact of the Court's ruling.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The Senate does not ratify constitutional amendments.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. There are no term limits for Supreme Court justices.		

Question 26

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.b Explain political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		MPA-3.A Describe the voting rights protections in the Constitution and in legislation.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. The Twenty-Fourth Amendment had no impact on access to places of public accommodation.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The Twenty-Fourth Amendment had no impact on the importance of the Speaker of the House of Representatives.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Gender was not the focus of the Twenty-Fourth Amendment.		
(D)	This option is correct. The Twenty-Fourth Amendment eliminated poll taxes.		

Question 27

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-3.A Describe the different structures, powers, and functions of each house of Congress.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. Creating immigration policies does not directly lead to hiring unemployed citizens.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Congress's enumerated interstate commerce power regulates commerce with foreign nations, among states, and with Native Americans.		
(C)	This option is correct. When passing a federal budget, Congress allocates funds to various programs; these could include a program to stimulate the economy by hiring unemployed citizens.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Congressional oversight includes reviewing, monitoring, and supervising various federal agencies, but it does not directly lead to economic stimuli programs.		

Question 28

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		PMI-2.B Explain how the federal bureaucracy uses delegated discretionary authority for rule making and implementation.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. The Supreme Court does not review any type of legislation annually.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. New legislation about automobile safety is very unlikely to ask states to manufacture automobiles.		
(C)	This option is correct. The Department of Transportation is the organization that has the authority to create new safety regulations for cars.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Mandatory spending on automobile safety legislation is highly unlikely and not required in all future federal budgeting.		

Question 29

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		MPA-2.A Describe the elements of a scientific poll.	4
(A)	This option is correct. Exit polls help predict election results by asking voters at randomly selected polling places whom they voted for.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Having a computer randomly select phone numbers nationally is useful for polls with random samples but does not describe an exit poll.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. False or misleading information is not part of the design of exit polls.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Exit polls focus on randomly sampling selected voting places, not just random samples of the population.		

Question 30

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-5.C Explain how other branches in the government can limit the Supreme Court's power.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. The Constitution states that Congress cannot reduce the salaries of justices.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. According to the Constitution, Congress cannot override a Supreme Court decision.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Congress does have the right to impeach a Supreme Court justice, but there must be good cause to do this. Impeaching the justices in the majority is not a step that Congress would take to lessen the impact of a decision.		
(D)	This option is correct. The Supreme Court has no authority to enforce any of its decisions. Therefore, the president and Congress could refuse to enforce a decision and thereby lessen the impact of the decision.		

Question 31

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.b Explain political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PRD-3.B Explain how increasingly diverse choices of media and communication outlets influence political institutions and behavior.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. Consumer-driven media often focuses on controversial topics rather than avoiding them.		
(B)	This option is correct. Consumer-driven media increase partisan polarization because it reinforces existing biases in individuals.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Relying on corporate advertising does not explain an increase in partisan polarization.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. There is both liberal and conservative consumer-driven media.		

Question 32

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-4.C Explain how presidents have interpreted and justified their use of formal and informal powers.	2
(A)	This option is correct. Hamilton argues in favor of a single executive that can respond quickly to crises.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The need for a president with a good understanding of public policy is not Hamilton's central argument.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Hamilton does not argue in favor of an electoral college in <i>The Federalist</i> 70.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The quotation refers to energy in the executive, but this is not an argument for a youthful president.		

Question 33

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		LOR-2.C Explain the extent to which the Supreme Court's interpretation of the First and Second Amendments reflects a commitment to individual liberty.	3
(A)	This option is incorrect. The Supreme Court held in <i>Engel v. Vitale</i> (1962) that school sponsorship of religious activities violates the establishment clause.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The Supreme Court held in <i>Wisconsin v. Yoder</i> (1972) that compelling Amish students to attend school past the eighth grade violated the free exercise clause.		
(C)	This option is correct. The Supreme Court held in <i>Tinker v. Des Moines Independent Community School District</i> (1969) that students' symbolic speech is protected under the First Amendment.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The Supreme Court held in <i>New York Times Company v. United States</i> (1971) that the government could not engage in prior restraint against the media.		

Question 34

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.b Explain political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-2.A Explain how societal needs affect the constitutional allocation of power between the national and state governments.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. Concurrent powers do not necessarily reinforce the powers of the national government and supremacy of national law.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Concurrent powers are powers that both states and the national government have, so they do not create separate spheres of influence.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Concurrent powers do not necessarily lead to cooperation between states and the national government, and they do not require the two levels of government to work together.		
(D)	This option is correct. Concurrent powers are powers that both states and the national government have. They make it possible for states and the national government to simultaneously exercise influence in the same areas of public policy.		

Question 35

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.d Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors illustrated in different scenarios in context.		CON-3.B Explain how the structure, powers, and functions of both houses of Congress affect the policy-making process.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. A senator from a coal-producing state voting against a job-training program for coal miners is the opposite of pork-barrel legislation.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The action described here—a member of the House voting for urban renewal in exchange for increase road funding—is not an illustration of pork-barrel legislation.		
(C)	This option is correct. Pork-barrel legislation is characterized as the appropriation of government funds for local projects that serve a representative's constituents. Therefore, a senator from an agricultural state amending legislation to establish a potato research institute is an illustration of this concept.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. A member of the House Armed Services Committee marking up a bill that will increase funding for military bases is not an example of a pork-barrel project, because the markup is for military bases in general, not a specific local constituency.		

Question 36

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		MPA-3.B Describe different models of voting behavior.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. It is common for voters to use party affiliations of the candidates when making vote choices, but this is not the most important consideration in the retrospective model of voting.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Campaign promises made by candidates are prospective and therefore not part of the retrospective model of voting.		
(C)	This option is correct. In the retrospective voting model, voters use recent events and conditions, such as the economy, to make their decision when voting.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Whether the candidates will act in the best interest of the voters if elected is not part of the retrospective model of voting.		

Question 37

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		CON-5.B Explain how the exercise of judicial review in conjunction with life tenure can lead to debate about the legitimacy of the Supreme Court's power.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. Briefs submitted by interested parties are called amicus curiae briefs.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Supreme Court justices are relatively shielded from societal norms and pressures when deciding cases.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. While Supreme Court justices may confer with each other when hearing cases, this is not a key factor in making decisions.		
(D)	This option is correct. Legal precedent refers to using rulings on prior cases as the basis for current cases, which is what Chief Justice Roberts was referring to when he made a statement about <i>Roe v. Wade</i> .		

Question 38

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PMI-4.E Explain how political ideologies vary on the role of the government in addressing social issues.	4
(A)	This option is incorrect. Libertarians do not advocate increasing income taxes on the wealthy.		
(B)	This option is correct. Libertarians believe that marijuana should be legalized and sold commercially and that the government should spend less on prisons.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Libertarians believe in fewer taxes but do not believe in government promotion of education.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Expanding the welfare state and reducing spending on defense are tenets of liberal ideology.		

Question 39

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.d Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors illustrated in different scenarios in context.		PMI-4.B Explain how U.S. political culture (e.g., values, attitudes, and beliefs) influences the formation, goals, and implementation of public policy over time.	4
(A)	This option is incorrect. The scenario does not illustrate anything about shifting political attitudes.		
(B)	This option is correct. The scenario illustrates the inherent tension between civil liberties and security.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The free-rider problem occurs when someone enjoys benefits without paying any costs, and it is not applicable in this case.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The impact of globalization is not best illustrated with the placement of security cameras in front of a public square.		

Question 40

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.d Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors illustrated in different scenarios in context.		MPA-1.B Explain how cultural factors influence political attitudes and socialization.	4
(A)	This option is correct. Important agents of political socialization include school, so an individual taking a civics course is a good example of the process of political socialization.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Members of Congress who vote the same way as other members of their party may be the result of actions such as political pressure, but they are not demonstrating political socialization.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. New members being offered access to a broad network of people is perhaps an example of socialization, but it is not an example of political socialization because there is no politics involved.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The consumption of new sources media is not a reflection of political socialization because there are many different types of media, and lots of media are not political.		

Question 41

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.d Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors illustrated in different scenarios in context.		PMI-2.C Explain how Congress uses its oversight power in its relationship with the executive branch.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. Lobbyists from any organization are not formal checks on the power of the bureaucracy.		
(B)	This option is correct. The secretary of defense is part of the bureaucracy, and calling on him or her to testify illustrates a formal check on power.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The White House chief of staff is part of the executive branch and is therefore not part of the bureaucracy.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The impeachment of a federal judge is a check on the judiciary, not on the bureaucracy.		

Question 42

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		MPA-2.A Describe the elements of a scientific poll.	4
(A)	This option is incorrect. The company did not necessarily save money by using this method.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. This method is not exclusively associated with benchmark polling.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. This method did not permit the company to ask different questions of different individuals.		
(D)	This option is correct. This method would help ensure a random sample, since many people no longer use telephone lines for communication.		

Question 43

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.c Compare political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		LOR-2.C Explain the extent to which the Supreme Court's interpretation of the First and Second Amendments reflects a commitment to individual liberty.	3
(A)	This option is incorrect. Libel and slander are not protected by the First Amendment.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Freedom of assembly is protected by the First Amendment.		
(C)	This option is correct. The right to burn a flag is protected by the First Amendment, however obscenity, although usually legal, is not always considered protected speech.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The right of a student to pray in school is protected by the First Amendment.		

Question 44

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.c Compare political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-1.B Explain the relationship between key provisions of the Articles of Confederation and the debate over granting the federal government greater power formerly reserved to the states.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. The Articles of Confederation did not contain specific protections of individual liberties. Such rights were instead enumerated in the first ten amendments to the United States Constitution.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The Articles of Confederation did not establish a strong federal union with a powerful executive branch, though the Constitution did establish federal supremacy in Article VI.		
(C)	This option is correct. Under the Articles of Confederation, legislation was approved by the unicameral Congress of the Confederation. The United States Constitution established a bicameral legislature consisting of the Senate and House of Representatives.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Amending the United States Constitution requires ratification by three-fourths of state legislatures or ratifying conventions but does not require presidential approval.		

Question 45

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.c Compare political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		CON-4.A Explain how the president can implement a policy agenda.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. Both the choice to veto and the choice to delay action on a bill to prevent it from becoming law are formal powers of the presidency under the United States Constitution.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The president's influence on public opinion is not a formal power of the presidency enumerated in the Constitution, while the appointing of ambassadors is a formal power explicitly outlined in the Constitution.		
(C)	This option is correct. The president's role as commander in chief of the armed forces is a formal power explicitly authorized in the Constitution. The signing of executive agreements with foreign nations is not included in the Constitution and is considered to be an informal power of the presidency.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Congress, not the president, controls the national budget.		

Question 46

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.c Compare political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PMI-5.G Explain how various political actors influence public policy outcomes.	5
(A)	This option is correct. Political parties primarily focus on running candidates for office, while interest groups seek to influence public policy.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Constituency size varies based on the geographical scope of the political office in question, but political parties frequently control large portions of a given constituency.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Political parties can do fund-raising for their candidates within the party organization, but they do not typically control external organizations. Interest groups are not barred from seeking to influence policy by donating to campaigns.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Political parties usually seek to make policy through legislation.		

Question 47

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
2.c Compare the reasoning, decisions, and opinion(s) of a required Supreme Court case to a non-required Supreme Court case.		CON-2.B Explain how the appropriate balance of power between national and state governments has been interpreted differently over time.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. Neither <i>Brown v. Board of Education of Topeka</i> nor <i>Baker v. Carr</i> dealt explicitly with issues of federalism.		
(B)	This option is correct. <i>McCulloch v. Maryland</i> established that states did not have the power to tax federal institutions, such as the Bank of the United States. <i>United States v. Lopez</i> demonstrated a shift in federal authority by ruling that the federal government could not establish gun-free zones under the commerce clause.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Neither <i>Roe v. Wade</i> nor <i>McDonald v. Chicago</i> dealt explicitly with issues of federalism.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Neither <i>Schenck v. United States</i> nor <i>New York Times v. United States</i> dealt explicitly with issues of federalism.		

Question 48

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.b Explain political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PRD-3.A Explain the media's role as a linkage institution.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. Media coverage of poll results does not necessarily have an impact on the level of partisanship among voters.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Media coverage of poll results does not necessarily have a negative impact on voter turnout.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Media coverage of poll results does not improve public understanding of the electoral process.		
(D)	This option is correct. Media coverage that focuses primarily on poll results devotes less time and resources to educating the electorate on matters of policy.		

Question 49

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		PMI-1.B Explain the implications of separation of powers and checks and balances for the U.S. political system.	1
(A)	This option is incorrect. The breaking of an electoral college tie by the House of Representatives is not an example of friction with the executive branch.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Impeachment proceedings in the Senate for offenses committed by the executive demonstrate effective checks and balances, not friction over separated powers.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The dispatch of the secretary of state along with the Senate delegation is within the power of the executive to negotiate treaties and conduct foreign affairs.		
(D)	This option is correct. The president's threat to legislate by executive order creates friction with the legislative branch, since passing laws is within the legislature's purview.		

Question 50

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.d Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors illustrated in different scenarios in context.		CON-3.C Explain how congressional behavior is influenced by election processes, partisanship, and divided government.	2
(A)	This option is incorrect. The dispatch of representatives to lobby for a particular reform on behalf of an interest group does not fall under a specific model of representation.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The passage of legislation to address a cause brought to the attention of Congress by a wave of popular protest more closely reflects a delegate model of representation.		
(C)	This option is correct. The trustee model of representation involves elected officials voting in whatever manner they feel best serves their constituents, regardless of popular opinion regarding the issue.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The proposals of a presidential candidate do not have an impact on policy and do not serve as a particular model of representation until the candidate is duly elected as a representative of the people.		

Question 51

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		PMI-5.F Explain how variation in types and resources of interest groups affects their ability to influence elections and policy making.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. Interest groups do not nominate slates of candidates; this is the function of political parties.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The protection of banking interests is more likely to appeal to Republicans, while the consumer protection group is more likely to appeal to Democrats.		
(C)	This option is correct. The institution representing banking interests most likely has resources that outweigh those of a group seeking to protect consumers.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Neither interest group is prohibited by federal regulations from direct lobbying.		

Question 52

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.		LOR-3.A Explain the implications of the doctrine of selective incorporation.	3
(A)	This option is correct. Selective incorporation ensures that states and localities cannot pass laws that infringe upon the rights guaranteed in the United States Constitution.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Conflict between the different branches of the federal government is not affected by selective incorporation, which ensures that states localities cannot pass laws that infringe upon the rights guaranteed in the United States Constitution.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Conflict over state versus federal authority for oversight is not affected by selective incorporation, which ensures that states and localities cannot pass laws that infringe upon the rights guaranteed in the United States Constitution.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. Wrongful termination suits that cross state lines are not affected by selective incorporation, which ensures that states and localities cannot pass laws that infringe upon the rights guaranteed in the United States Constitution.		

Question 53

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.b Explain political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PRD-3.B Explain how increasingly diverse choices of media and communication outlets influence political institutions and behavior.	5
(A)	This option is incorrect. Investigative reporting tends to compose a smaller part of the news because it typically requires more resources than political commentary.		
(B)	This option is correct. The increased popularity of 24-hour news networks and online media emerged from public demand for instant coverage of news events.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Media in the United States, though influenced by interest groups, is not in the control of major political parties.		
(D)	This option is incorrect. The increased consumption of news content from the Internet and the influence of social media have created a greater number of outlets for public opinion rather than consolidating control in the hands of media conglomerates.		

Question 54

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
2.d Explain how required Supreme Court cases apply to scenarios in context.		LOR-2.C Explain the extent to which the Supreme Court's interpretation of the First and Second Amendments reflects a commitment to individual liberty.	3
(A)	This option is incorrect. The interstate commerce clause allows the federal government to regulate commerce between the states, and the establishment of prayer at a football game would not violate this constitutional principle.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. The free exercise clause guarantees individuals the freedom to practice their religion, but it does not prohibit the establishment of laws or policies based on religion.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. The supremacy clause establishes the primacy of the federal Constitution over state laws, which has no bearing on the establishment of prayer at a football game.		
(D)	This option is correct. The establishment clause prohibits the government from creating any law or policy that favors a specific religion or institutionalizes its religious practice and belief.		

Question 55

Disciplinary Practice		Enduring Understanding/ Learning Objective	Unit
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.		PMI-4.A Explain how ideologies of the two major parties shape policy debates.	4
(A)	This option is incorrect. Democrats do not support reducing regulations on Wall Street.		
(B)	This option is incorrect. Democrats support increasing the role of the federal government to ensure access to health care.		
(C)	This option is incorrect. Democrats do not support increasing the enforcement of immigration laws.		
(D)	This option is correct. Democrats support antidiscrimination policies for gay couples getting married.		

Scoring Guidelines and Notes for Question 1

Course Framework Alignment

Disciplinary Practice(s)	Enduring Understanding/Learning Objective	Unit(s)
1.a Describe political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors. 1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.	PMI-2.C Explain how Congress uses its oversight power in its relationship with the executive branch. PMI-2.E Explain the extent to which governmental branches can hold the bureaucracy accountable given the competing interests of Congress, the president, and the federal courts. PMI-4.A Explain how ideologies of the two major parties shape policy debates.	Unit 2 Unit 4

Scoring Guidelines

Maximum Possible Points: 3

Rubric Row	Scoring Criteria	Scoring Note
A Describe (0–1 point)	1 point Describe a political institution, behavior, or process in connection with a scenario.	The response must reference content from the scenario and provide a description.
B Explain (0–1 point)	1 point In the context of the scenario, explain how the response in part A affects a political process, government entity, or citizen behavior.	The response needs to specify an action and the impact of that action.
C Explain (0–1 point)	1 point Explain how the scenario relates to a political institution, behavior, or process.	To earn this point, the response must demonstrate a grasp of the appropriate Enduring Understanding.

Scoring Notes

Criteria	Examples of types of responses that would meet the criteria	Notes
Describe an action, other than advancing legislation, that members of Congress may take to bring transparency and accountability to the Federal Reserve.	• Committees can hold hearings, where members of the Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve testify in front of members of Congress. • The Senate can refuse to confirm members of the Federal Reserve Board.	Response should include more information than stating that Congress can pass a law to audit the Federal Reserve.
In the context of this scenario, explain how the proposal to increase transparency and accountability would affect the Federal Reserve's ability to make economic policy.	• The Federal Reserve would be less independent. • The Federal Reserve would be more attentive to the political pressures when making decisions affecting monetary policy.	Response should include more information than stating that the Federal Reserve would be more transparent/accountable, and would lose its ability to make policies.
Explain how ideological differences between the parties might affect Democratic Party support of the proposal.	• The Democratic Party believes in more regulation of the economy and thus would not support the proposal by Republicans, which might lead the Federal Reserve to be more attentive to Republican priorities which includes less regulation.	Response should include more information than stating that the Democratic Party believes in more regulation of the economy and thus would support the proposal.

Scoring Guidelines and Notes for Question 2

Course Framework Alignment

Disciplinary Practice(s)	Enduring Understanding/Learning Objective	Unit(s)
3.a Describe the data presented. 3.b Describe patterns and trends in data. 3.d Explain what the data imply or illustrate about political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors.	CON-4.B Explain how the president’s agenda can create tension and frequent confrontations with Congress. LOR-2.B Describe the rights protected in the Bill of Rights. PMI-4.C Describe different political ideologies on the role of government in regulating the marketplace.	Unit 2 Unit 3 Unit 4

Scoring Guidelines

Maximum Possible Points: 4

Rubric Row		Scoring Criteria	Scoring Note
A	Identify/Describe (0–1 point)	1 point Identify or describe the data.	
B1	Describe (0–1 point)	1 point Describe a pattern, trend, or similarity/difference as prompted.	
B2	Draw a conclusion (0–1 point)	1 point Draw a conclusion for that similarity or difference.	
C	Explain (0–1 point)	1 point Explain how _____ in the stimulus graphic demonstrates _____.	To earn this point, the response must demonstrate a grasp of the appropriate Enduring Understanding.

Scoring Notes

Criteria	Examples of types of responses that meet the criteria	Notes
Describe a trend in presidential nominees to district courts with regard to gender. (1 point)	- The percentage of female appointees has generally increased over time. - Democrats tend to appoint a higher percentage of females than Republicans do.	Responses that identify a data point but not a trend do not earn a point.
Describe a similarity or difference between Republican and Democratic presidential nominees with regard to the political party of those they nominate. (1 point)	- One difference is that Democrats tend to nominate Democrats, and Republicans tend to nominate Republicans. - The parties are similar in that they nominate members of their own party.	Response must compare Democrats and Republicans and cannot simply identify data.
Explain how the similarity or difference affects the judicial decisions of the federal district courts with regard to civil liberties. (1 point)	- Democratic appointees tend to support civil liberties in areas regarding privacy issues, suspect rights, and free speech cases. - Republicans appointees tend to support civil liberties on Second Amendment cases and religious freedom cases.	Response must specify a result or an impact of the difference noted in the previous section of B.
Explain how the number and party affiliation of judicial appointments affects presidential influence and power. (1 point)	- Judicial appointees will likely support the same policies as the president. The more appointees that are appointed, the more likely it is that policies supported by the president will be upheld. - Presidents seek to appoint as many nominees as they can from their own party as a way to ensure a lasting legacy. Judicial appointees to the federal courts have lifetime tenure and have the ability to continue handing down decisions in line with the president's party long after the president has served in office.	Responses such as "Democratic will uphold democratic policies" is not sufficient because it doesn't explain how the number of appointees affects presidential influence. Responses such as "The more appointments, the more power" do not adequately explain how the appointments increase power.

Scoring Guidelines and Notes for Question 3

Course Framework Alignment

Disciplinary Practice(s)	Enduring Understanding/Learning Objective	Unit(s)
2.a Describe the facts, reasoning, decision, and opinion(s) of required Supreme Court cases. 2.c Compare the reasoning, decisions, and opinion(s) of a required Supreme Court case to a non-required Supreme Court case. 1.e Explain how political principles, institutions, processes, policies, and behaviors apply to different scenarios in context.	CON-2.B Explain how the appropriate balance of power between national and state governments has been interpreted differently over time. CON-3.A Describe the different structures, powers, and functions of each house of Congress.	Unit 1 Unit 2

Scoring Guidelines

Maximum Possible Points: 4

Rubric Row		Scoring Criteria	Scoring Note
A	Identify (0–1 point)	1 point Identify a similarity or difference between the two Supreme Court cases (as specified in the question).	
B1	Identify (0–1 point)	1 point Provide prompted information from the specified required Supreme Court case.	
B2	Explain (0–1 point)	1 point Explain how or why that information is relevant to the second source provided in the question. (Explain the relationship of that information as directed.)	In order to earn the second point in part B, the response must correctly relate specific information from the required source to the new source.
C	Describe or Explain (0–1 point)	1 point Describe or explain an interaction between the holding in the non-required Supreme Court case and a relevant political institution, behavior, or process.	To earn this point, the response must demonstrate a grasp of the appropriate Enduring Understanding.

Scoring Notes

Criteria	Examples of types of responses that meet the criteria	Notes
Identify a common constitutional principle used to make a ruling in both cases. (1 point)	Supremacy clause	
Explain how the facts in <i>McCulloch v. Maryland</i> and <i>Arizona v. United States</i> led to a similar holding in both cases. (2 points) - Describe the facts about <i>McCulloch v. Maryland</i>. (1 point) - Correctly explain how the facts of both cases led to the same holding. (1 point)	- In <i>McCulloch</i>, the state of Maryland passed legislation to impose taxes on the nationally established bank. The Court ruled that federal government has the power to create a bank under its powers to collect taxes, borrow money, and regulate interstate commerce. The necessary and proper clause permits the federal government to pass any laws “necessary and proper” for its execution of these powers. It also found that “the power to tax, was the power to destroy,” and thus, Maryland’s tax violated the Supremacy Clause. - In <i>Arizona</i>, the state sought to pass a law about immigration enforcement that would undermine the federal government’s constitutional right to regulate and enforce immigration policy. The Court ruled in favor of the federal government’s power to interpret immigration policy under the Supremacy Clause. - In both cases, the court found in favor of the federal government, and the Supremacy Clause was used in the decision.	Discussion must include the <i>McCulloch</i> case facts, and not just the holding, to earn the point. Discussion must also include how the supremacy clause or the necessary and proper clause was used in the ruling in favor of the national government.
Describe an action that Congress could take to respond to the <i>Arizona v. United States</i> decision if it disagreed with the decision. (1 point)	Congress could pass a law granting the states more authority to determine how to regulate and enforce immigration laws.	

Scoring Guidelines and Notes for Question 4

Course Framework Alignment

Disciplinary Practice(s)	Enduring Understanding/Learning Objective	Unit(s)
5.a Articulate a defensible claim/thesis. 5.b Support the argument using relevant evidence. 5.c Use reasoning to organize and analyze evidence, explaining its significance to justify the claim or thesis. 5.d Use refutation, concession, or rebuttal in responding to opposing or alternate perspectives.	CON-3.A Describe the different structures, powers, and functions of each house of Congress. CON-5.A Explain the principle of judicial review and how it checks the power of other institutions and state governments. PRD-1.A Explain how constitutional provisions have supported and motivated social movements. MPA-1.A Explain the relationship between core beliefs of U.S. citizens and attitudes about the role of government.	Unit 2 Unit 3 Unit 4

Scoring Guidelines

Maximum Possible Points: 6

Rubric Row	Scoring Criteria			Scoring Note
Claim/ Thesis	1 point Articulates a defensible claim or thesis that responds to the question and establishes a line of reasoning.			The response cannot earn a point for simply restating the prompt.
Evidence	1 point Provides one piece of evidence that is accurately linked to the topic of the question	OR 2 points Uses one piece of specific and relevant evidence to support the claim or thesis	OR 3 points Uses two pieces of specific and relevant evidence to support the claim or thesis	To earn more than one point, the response must have a claim/thesis.
Reasoning	1 point Explains how or why the evidence supports the claim or thesis			The response must have a claim/thesis to earn a point. The response cannot simply restate the prompt to explain why the evidence supports the claim/thesis. The response cannot earn a point without previously supporting the claim/thesis in B. To earn the point the response must address at least one piece of evidence.
Responds to alternative perspectives	1 point Responds to an opposing or alternate perspective using refutation, concession, or rebuttal			The response must have a claim or thesis to earn a point. The response must identify an alternative perspective; demonstrate a correct understanding of the perspective; and refute, concede, or rebut the perspective.

Scoring Notes

	Criteria	Examples of types of responses that would meet criteria	Notes
A	Articulates a defensible claim or thesis that responds to the question and establishes line of reasoning (1 point)	“Congress/the Supreme Court is most responsible for advancing the principle of equality of opportunity because _____.”	The response cannot earn the point for thesis simply by picking Congress or the Supreme Court and repeating prompt that it “is most responsible for advancing the principle.”
B	Provides one (or more) piece(s) of evidence that is accurately linked to the topic of the question (1 point)	Correct statement/evidence about Congress or the Supreme Court, but does not match model or thesis accurately.	The response cites a correct piece of information about the role of Congress or the Supreme Court but does not address the issue of equality of opportunity.
OR			
B	Uses one piece of relevant evidence to support the claim or thesis (2 points)	- Congress—Passing the 14th amendment. - Federalist #78—Supreme Court and judicial review - The Declaration of Independence—Congress is elected (government by consent). - The Declaration of Independence—Supreme Court (court is independent of executive/a monarch)	The response cites a correct piece of information about how Congress or the Supreme Court advances equality of opportunity.
OR			
B	Uses two pieces of relevant evidence to support the claim or thesis (3 points)	“Congress has the power of the purse, so it can fund programs to advance equality.” “Members of Congress oftentimes interact directly with people and understand issues of inequality more than judges do.” “Members of the Supreme Court are not elected, and therefore, are impervious to public opinion when it opposes equality.”	Second piece of evidence may be from a student’s knowledge of Congress or the Supreme Court.

	Criteria	Examples of types of responses that would meet criteria	Notes
C	Uses reasoning to explain why evidence supports claim/thesis (1 point)	• “Congress can pass amendments that foster equality, such as the 14th amendment, which guarantees each individual equal protection under the law and due process.” • “Federalist #78 argues in favor of judicial review, which the Supreme Court has used to evaluate the constitutionality of laws or actions that affect equality, such as in the <i>Brown v. Board of Education</i> decision, which struck down segregation in schools.” • “The Declaration of Independence declared that “all men are created equal” and that the powers of government are derived by consent. Congress is the only directly elected federal branch of government, making it the most likely to pass laws to uphold the principle of equality. Congress passed the Americans with Disabilities Act which allowed people with disabilities greater access to resources.”	The response cannot simply restate the prompt
D	Responds to an opposing or alternative perspective using refutation, concession, or rebuttal (1 point)	• The response correctly illustrates an opposing or alternative perspective (Congress/the Supreme Court) and responds to it.	The response must be more than just acknowledging another view, such as “While some say the Congress/ Supreme Court best advances the principle of equality of opportunity, I say otherwise.”

Free-Response Questions	Question Type	Enduring Understandings/ Learning Objectives	Unit
1	Concept Application	PMI-2.C, PMI-2.E, PMI-4.A	2, 4
2	Quantitative Analysis	CON-4.B, LOR-2.B, PMI-4.C	2, 3, 4
3	SCOTUS Comparison	CON-2.B, CON-3.A	1, 2
4	Argument Essay	CON-3.A, CON-5.A, PRD-1.A, MPA-1.A	2, 3, 4